



Funtouch OS 13 announced

Funtouch OS 13 has been revealed and the Vivo X80 Pro is already the first phone to get it. <https://digit.in/nov22-41>



Age of Empires on mobile!

Microsoft has announced that Age Of Empires will be coming to mobile devices. <https://digit.in/nov22-42>

Google Pixel Buds Pro

Good first attempt at Pro TWS earbuds

With the latest Google Pixel Buds Pro, Google has finally taken the plunge into the flagship wireless earphones segment. The Pixel Buds Pro takes on heavy-weights from brands such as Sony, Apple, Bose, Sennheiser, and others. But do they deliver on the hype? Here's everything you should know.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The Google Pixel Buds Pro looks nearly identical to the original Pixel Buds and the newer Pixel Buds A-series. It has a Tamagotchi-esque charging case with Qi wireless charging support. It is pocketable and looks premium enough with a matte texture and a dual-tone design. It houses the USB-C charging port, an LED, and a pairing button. A simple flick of a thumb will open up the case with ease. The hinge isn't reinforced with metal, so the durability may not be the best in this price range. The buds themselves are diminutive in size and quite lightweight. They lack the silicone extensions or wings. There are three sizes of ear tips provided – S, M, and L – but none of them gave the reviewer a tight and snug fit. The back of the bud houses the Google logo and the capacitive touch sensor. You also get IPX4 water resistance on the earbuds and an IPX2 rating on the case.

FEATURES

The onboard controls on the Google Pixel Buds Pro are incredibly intuitive and Google has even included swipe volume controls. Unfortunately, though, the earbud controls are not fully customisable via the Pixel Buds app. You can use the app to access various features such as checking battery levels, performing firmware updates, checking ear tip fit (which seems to be broken because it always says good fit, for some reason), and toggle features. It has Multipoint connectivity and Audio Switching

which intelligently switches between Android phones and tablets that worked flawlessly. Sadly, there are no customisable EQ or EQ presets available and the app is not available for iOS devices. Other features include Google Fast Pair support, in-ear detection for auto pause and play, and Find My Earbuds feature. It also comes equipped with ANC and Transparency Mode. Google introduced Silent Seal that adapts to your ear shape and delivers noise-cancelling that best suits your ear shape. We found the ANC to be pretty effective – especially with low-end, constant sounds. Transparency Mode pleasantly surprised us with how natural and clear it sounded.

PERFORMANCE

Google Assistant worked flawlessly, especially when using the Translate Conversation Mode. Moving on to sound quality, the Google Pixel Buds Pro house 11mm dynamic drivers and supports the SBC and AAC audio codecs. They come with a V-shaped sound signature with slightly boosted bass and highs, and slightly recessed mids. The boosted bass sounds punchy and full-bodied and the highs have good enough clarity but the mids are slightly drowned in the mix. Vocals

in certain songs aren't as detailed and clear as heard on similarly-priced buds. In some tracks, the kick drums sound a bit too boomy. However, if you are an audiophile or someone who enjoys a more neutral sound signature, we'd suggest alternatives such as the Sony WF-1000XM4 or even the Oppo Enco X2. The wireless connectivity is also stellar with Bluetooth 5.0. The buds feature three microphones in each bud paired with voice accelerometers and wind-blocking mesh covers. The caller's voice sounds clear in most cases. However, it doesn't do too well with wind rejection, sometimes picking up wind more than the caller's voice.



BUILD	80
FEATURES	87
PERFORMANCE	75
VALUE	70

BATTERY LIFE

The Google Pixel Buds Pro's battery life is fantastic, right up there with the competition. We tested the buds' battery life for ourselves and recorded 6 hours and 35 minutes of playtime on the buds alone with ANC turned on and the volume set to 70 per cent. The case

adds two extra charges. Not just that, the earphones also have fast charging support where a mere 5-minute charge will provide an hour's worth of playtime.

VERDICT

Google's first attempt at Pro TWS earbuds is a successful one. At ₹19,990, the Pixel Buds Pro has fantastic handsfree Google Assistant integration, great battery life, and decent ANC. The sound quality is quite pleasant as well with detailed lows and highs.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

DRIVER UNIT: 11 mm dynamic driver | IP RATING: IPX4 (earbuds), IPX2 (charging case) | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | MICROPHONE: Triple microphone on each bud | BATTERY LIFE (ANC ON): 7 hours (earbuds), 20 hours (buds + case) | BATTERY LIFE (ANC OFF): 11 hours (earbuds), 31 hours (buds + case) | FAST CHARGING: Yes, 5 minutes = 1 hour | WEIGHT: 6.1 g (each bud), 50.6 g (case without buds)

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